Game files

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Modding

Give your feedback on the Modding Wiki here (https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSdxBWwKUcNP_KbzmmWo1eNc2QkpWk5dTj4PMhuNLY9_dc4IEw/viewform?usp=header)!

Category:Modding • Scripts • Lua (API) • Java • User Interface • Modeling • Animation • Texturing • Mapping • Rendering • Translation

This page has been updated to an *unstable* beta version (42.12.3).

This article is about game files of Project Zomboid. For modding structure of Project Zomboid, see Mod structure. For explanations of file formats, see File formats.

This page describes the **game files** of Project Zomboid and how to access them. This page will list where different types of files can be found.

Accessing the game files

The game folder holds most of the game code, files, textures, maps, models etc. Accessing the game files of Project Zomboid can be easily achieved through Steam:

- Open your Steam game library

- Right click on Project Zomboid > Manage > Browse local files
- Alternatively you can rick click Project Zomboid > Properties > Installed files > Browse

This should open a folder named `ProjectZomboid/` with a similar path to this:

```
Steam/
└── steamapps/
    └── common/
        └── ProjectZomboid/
            └── ...
```

Also check this video (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5LCGwCk7RH4) which explains two different methods of finding the files.

Cache folder

The cache folder (named `Zomboid` by default) holds most of your configuration of the game, as well as local mods, and doesn't get deleted when you uninstall the game, holding all your configurations. To access the folder in Windows, simply use the environment variable `%UserProfile%` in the file explorer. The cache folder will be located at:

```
%UserProfile%/
└── Zomboid/
    └── ...
```

Deleting this folder can sometimes fix some game issues, however this will delete your game settings and saves, which you can backup before doing so.

You can change your cache folder with the startup parameter `-cachedir=<String Path>`. If the folder doesn't exist, the game will create it.

Console file

The console file is the game log file which contains informations about the state of the game, errors, warnings and other useful informations for debugging. This file is created when the game is launched. Prints will show up in the console file.

The console file is located at the following path:

```
%UserProfile%/
└── Zomboid/
    └── console.txt
```

Media folder

Most of the files which you'll be interested in when modding will be located in:

```
Steam/
└── steamapps/
    └── common/
        └── ProjectZomboid/
            └── media/
                └── ...
```

Java files

The Java files of the game are located in the `zombie` folder. Tools exist to decompile the Java code to make it easier to read. Below is the path to the Java files:

```
Steam/
└── steamapps/
    └── common/
        └── ProjectZomboid/
```

```
    └── zombie/
        └── ...
```

Searching the game files

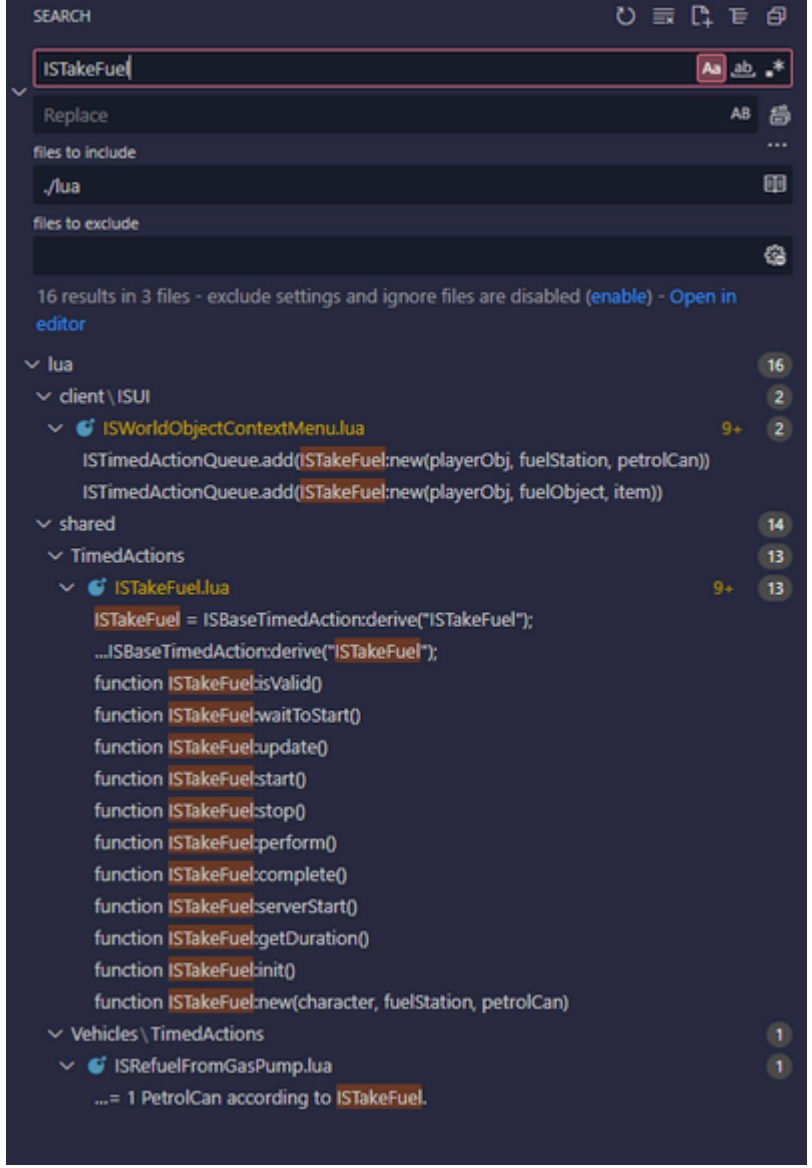
Tools exist to search through the entirety of the game files for specific elements in the game code. Integrated development environment (IDE) are notably the most common ones used by modders since they allow you to search for specific terms inside text files in an entire workspace:

- Visual Studio Code - a free IDE developped by Microsoft. Very easy to use and navigate and a few addons exist to help modding.
- IntelliJ IDEA - a free IDE developped by JetBrains. It is a bit more complex to use than Visual Studio Code but has a lot of features and is very powerful especially to navigate the Java.

Open the entire game folder as a workspace in the IDE of your choice to be able to search through all the files. You can open the `media/` folder or the decompiled code as a workspace to search through all the files.

Example

If you're searching for where something is used in Project Zomboid's code, you can simply use this functionality. For example, let's search for ISTakeFuel in VSCode:



See also

- Mod structure
- workshop.txt
- mod.info
- File formats - a section details tools to import the DirectX assets into modern formats.

Navigation

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